GGG-F-570a
January 29, 1966
SUPERSEDING
Int. Fed. Spec. GGG-F-00570 (Air Force-MOA)
July 13, 1964

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

FORCEPS, SHEET HOLDER

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 This specification covers one type of forceps used for inserting and removing sheet holders during fabrication of components from sheet metal.

1.1.1 *Federal specification coverage.* Federal specifications do not include all varieties of the commodity as indicated by the title of the specification, or which are commercially available, but are intended to cover only those generally used by the Federal Government.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following specifications and standards, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 102—Preservation, Packaging, and Packing Levels.
Fed. Std. No. 123—Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civilian Agencies).
Fed. Test Method Std. No. 151—Metals; Test Methods.

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D.C. 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration, Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D.C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, Wash.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established points in their agencies.)

Military Specifications:

MIL-H-795—Holders, Sheet Metal, Hole and Edge Grip.
MIL-H-15424—Hand Tools, Packaging of.

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105—Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129—Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 **Material.** The forceps shall be forged from steel of such quality that when proper-

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ly heat treated will comply with the applicable requirements hereinafter specified.

3.1.1 *Illustration.* Except for dimensional requirements, the illustration shown herein is for the convenience of identification and is not intended to preclude the purchase of forceps which are otherwise in accordance with the requirements of this specification.

3.2 Design. The forceps shall be designed substantially in accordance with figure 1 and shall be properly proportioned in all parts so as to be strong, durable and easy to operate.

3.3 Construction. The forceps shall be so designed that the head and necked down portion of the sheet holder will rest in counterbored seats of both jaws of the forceps. The

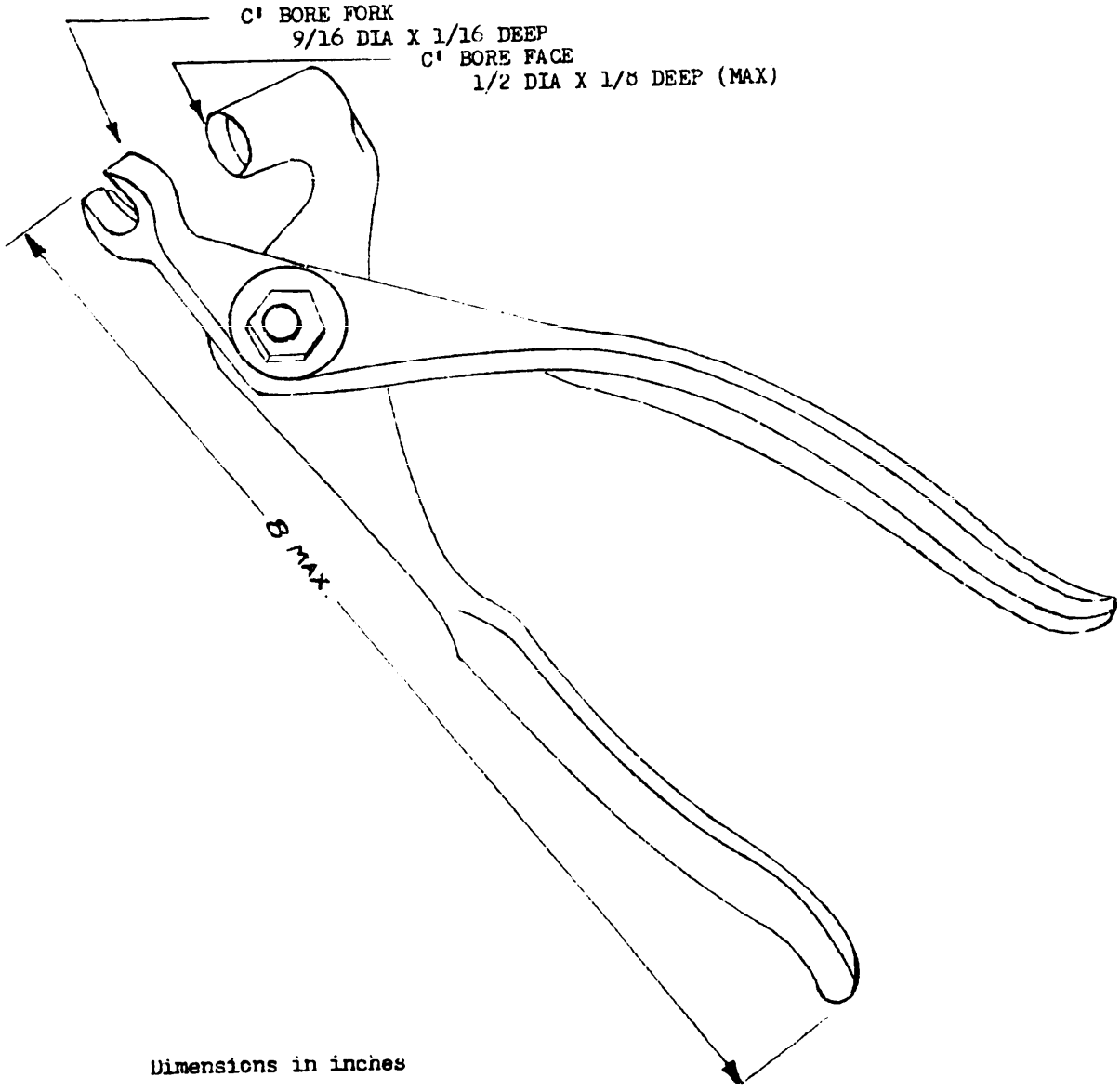


FIGURE 1. Sheet holder forceps

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minimum opening of the forceps shall be one inch and shall accommodate sheet holders conforming to MIL-H-795, type I, class 2 and type II, classes 2 and 3.

3.3.1 *Hardness.* The forceps shall have a Rockwell "C" hardness of 35 to 50 when tested as specified in 4.3.2.

3.3.2 *Joint.* The joint shall operate freely and smoothly, without wedging or binding, throughout the entire range of opening and closing. There shall be no excessive side movement, play, or other looseness when the forceps are opened or closed.

3.3.3 *Handles.* The handles shall be designed to afford a comfortable grip and shall be free from rough edges and sharp corners. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.1), the outer handgripping surfaces shall be smooth, knurled, or impressed.

3.4 **Weight.** The weight of the forceps shall not exceed nine ounces.

3.5 **Load test.** The forceps shall be capable of withstanding the load test as specified in 4.3.1.

3.6 **Finish and coatings.**

3.6.1 *Surface.* All surfaces shall be free of pits, nodules, burrs, cracks, iron oxide, and foreign substances.

3.6.2 *Coating.* The forceps shall be electroplated with either nickel, zinc, cadmium, or chromium. The plated surface shall be smooth and continuous.

3.7 **Marking.** The forceps shall be marked in a permanent manner, showing the manufacturer's name, symbol, or trademark.

3.8 **Workmanship.** Workmanship shall be in accordance with best commercial practices for this type equipment. The forceps shall be free from all sharp projections, burrs, or rough edges.

3.9 **Safety feature.** The upper and lower seats in the forcep jaws shall be so designed that the sheet holder may not accidentally slip out of the jaws and cause personal injury.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 **Responsibility for inspection.** Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 **Sampling for inspection and acceptance.** Sampling for inspection and acceptance shall be made in accordance with the provisions set forth in MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated hereinafter.

4.2.1 *Component and material inspection.* In accordance with 4.1, the supplier is responsible for insuring that components and materials used were manufactured, tested, and inspected in accordance with the specified requirements of referenced subsidiary specifications and standards to the extent specified herein, or, if none, in accordance with this specification.

4.2.2 *End item inspection.* The inspection lot shall consist of all forceps offered for acceptance at one time. The sample unit for this inspection shall be one complete forcep.

4.2.2.1 *Visual examination.* Examination of the end item shall be in accordance with the classification of defects set forth in table I. The inspection level shall be level II with the acceptable quality level (AQL) of 2.5 for major, and 6.5 for total defects expressed in terms of defects per hundred units.

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TABLE I. *Classification of defects*

Examine	Defect	Classification	
		Major	Minor
Finish----	Not plated ---------	X	
	Not smooth or uniform ----------		X
Construction and workmanship-----	Does not operate smoothly and freely through full opening and closing -------	X	
	Side movement, play, or other looseness--	X	
	Not comfortable grip	X	
	Handles not free of rough edges and sharp corners -----	X	
Marking--	Missing, not legible, or incomplete -----		X

4.2.2.2 *Dimensional examination.* Examination shall be made for compliance with dimensional requirements specified herein. The inspection level shall be S-3 with an AQL of 1.5 defects expressed in terms of defects per hundred units.

4.2.2.3 *End item testing.* Each sample unit shall be tested in accordance with 4.3.1. The inspection level shall be S-2 with an AQL of 2.5 defects expressed in terms of defects per hundred units.

4.3 Test procedures.

4.3.1 *Load test.* Each sample forcep shall have a 1/2 inch diameter by 1 inch long steel pin placed lengthwise between the jaws. A closing load of 80 pounds shall be applied 1/2 inch from the end of the handles. With the pin and the load removed, the forceps shall be checked for operation by inserting and removing the sheet holders in a manner simulating the conditions under which the forceps will be used in actual practice. Any evidence of failure shall be cause for rejection.

4.3.2 *Hardness test.* The Rockwell hardness test shall be in accordance with Fed. Test Method Std. No. 151.

4.4 Inspection of preparation for delivery requirements. An inspection shall be made to determine that the packaging, packing, and marking comply with the requirements in section 5. Defects shall be scored in accordance with table II. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL shall be 4.0 defects per hundred units.

TABLE II. *Classification of preparation for delivery defects*

Examine	Defects
Markings (exterior and interior) ----	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Materials ---------	Any component missing or damaged.
Workmanship -----	Inadequate application of components such as incomplete closure of container flaps, loose strapping, inadequate stapling. Distortion of container.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

(For civil agency procurement, the definitions and application of levels of packaging and packing shall be in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 102.)

5.1 Preservation, packaging, and packing. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.1), the forceps shall be preserved, packaged, and packed in accordance with MIL-H-15424. The levels of preservation and packaging shall be A or C and the level of packing A, B, or C as specified (see 6.1).

5.1.1 As part of the requirements of section 5 of this specification, the following is considered a part of table I of MIL-H-15424:

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Col. 1	Col. 2	Col. 3	Col. 4	Col. 6	Col. 7
Forceps, sheet holder, straight type	None	IC	6	24	144

5.2 **Marking.**

5.2.1 *Civil agencies.* In addition to markings required by the contract or order (see 6.1), the packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.2.3 *Military activities.* In addition to markings required by the contract or order (see 6.1), the packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 **Ordering data.** Purchasers should exercise any desired options offered herein and procurement documents should specify the following:

(*a*) Title, number, and date of this specification.

(*b*) Required level of preservation, packaging, and packing (see 5.1).

(*c*) Design of handles, if other than specified (see 3.3.3).

(*d*) Any special marking required (see 5.2).

6.2 **Transportation descriptions.** Transportation descriptions and minimum weights applicable to this commodity are:

Rail:

Tools, not otherwise indexed by name.
Carload minimum weight 30,000 pounds.

Motor:

Tools, hand, not otherwise indexed, other than power.
Truckload minimum weight 30,000 pounds, subject to Rule 115, National Motor Freight Classification.

CUSTODIANS:

Army—GL

Navy—SH

Air Force—69

Review Activities:

Army—GL

Navy—SH

Air Force—69

GSA—FSS

User Activities:

Army—MO

Navy—WP, YD, NC

Preparing Activity:

Air Force—69

Orders for this publication are to be placed with General Services Administration, acting as an agent for the Superintendent of Documents. See section 2 of this specification to obtain extra copies and other documents referenced herein. Price 5 cents each.

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